Soft Power:

A Comedy in Three Canticas[1]

Part I:

Objective-C Or Relative[2]

Narrated By Tyrese Paulsen[3]

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[1] *The Divine Comedy* by Dante (originally *Comedia)*, one of the text's main influences, also written in three canticas: Inferno, Pergatoria and Paradiso.

[2] *Hamlet and his Problems* by T.S. Eliot, where he introduces the idea of the objective correlative. Hamlet, Eliot, Shakespeare and the objective correlative feature heavily. Also Objective-C and Relative are both programming language terms, setting up for technological twists later on in the story .

[3] Tiresias (the mythical transgender soothsayer and character in The Waste Land, The Odyssey, The Breasts of Tiresias and Antigone) and Robert Paulsen from Fight Club (who had breasts).

Act I

Maundy Thursday

But most of us turn slow to see
The figure hanging on a tree
And stumble on and blindly grope
Upheld by intermittent hope,
God grant before we die we all
May see the light as did St. Paul.

The Conversion of St. Paul, John Betjeman[4]

[4] Betjeman is important for many reasons: attended Highgate where he was taught by T.S. Eliot, lived in Hampstead/Camden where the action is based, dropped out of Magdalen College Oxford as does one of the main characters, became Poet Laureate and has a statue at Kings Cross where one of the main characters arrives from Paris on the Eurostar. This poem is also about a crisis of confidence/faith, a main theme of the first book.

I

Elleh Toledot[5]

There is no fate that cannot be surmounted by scorn.[6]

The only soul made brave enough to tell the tale[7],
You can call me the designated Raphael[8].
Follow close past sickened hearts out the bitter cold[9]
To a yet unknowing subterranean world[10].

Here we are, Sunset in Camden[11]. Police sirens
Singing in the rain drowned by the environment,
Acrid mist rising from the blackened wood[12] beading
In fat pear-shaped tears resting on the low ceiling.

Some eyes here he'd met before, some were only types[13],
The garden overflowed with fruit most overripe,
Softening with bitterness, much like this rotten state[14]
Of mind that he'd been demarcated with of late.

Appalled but drawn to parricidal decisions,
Caught in static semantic disposition[15],
Here Joly stands, too scared-stiff to face the jury,
Clutching empty bottles from a bought-out brewery[16].

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[5] Means "these are the generations of", and is frequently repeated in the Book of Genesis. While connecting the first canto to Genesis isn't particularly innovative, this also sets up the link to Nas' album Illmatic, to which every canto has a link to the equivalent number canto/song. The first track of Illmatic is called The Genesis. The work also references several generations (Beat, X, Y, Lost, Golden, Greatest) and compares them to the current generation, so this also alludes to that. The work can also be read to start from the title, so the first sentence would be "these are the generations of the only soul left brave enough to tell the tale, you can call me the designated Raphael".

[6] Albert Camus, "The Myth of Sisyphus"

[7] As in All Along the Watchtower by Bob Dylan and DAMN by Kendrick Lamar, the last line of the book leads into the first, so the book can be read cyclically and the chronology is uncertain. It becomes apparent in the last line that this book is the account of the saga as told to the police by Tyrese, the last person left for them to question at the scene.

[8] Archangel who is partial narrator in Milton's *Paradise Lost* and Haydn's *The Creation* (based on Genesis/Psalms and Paradise Lost), both masterpieces for their authors. Heroic/epic verse is clunky but helps to cast Joly as Aeneas/Hamlet style anti-hero.

[9] For this relief much thanks; 'tis bitter cold and I am sick at heart. - Hamlet (1.1.10), Francisco to Barnardo

[10] Hamlet: Act 5, Scene 2, line 380, Horatio. "Let me speak to th' yet-unknowing world how these things came about"

[11] *Singing in the Rain,* Debbie Reynolds to Gene Kelly as he steps into her car & drops him at Camden Drive/Sunset Boulevard.

[12] First canto of Dante's Inferno is in the Dark Wood.

[13] Each main character in this story is based a different MBTI indicator. Joly is ISFP. We are all one of 16 types. Almost as if it were programmed...

[14] Hamlet (1.4), Marcellus to Horatio. "Something is rotten in the state of Denmark."

[15] Hamlet (I. v. 170, 172), Hamlet. "As I perchance hereafter shall think meet to put an antic disposition on."

[16] https://www.theguardian.com/business/2015/dec/21/camden-town-brewery-sold-inbev-worlds-biggest-drinks-company

He wasn't even meant to be out late tonight.
Now he shares a dark dancefloor with nocturnal sprites,
Molochs[17] and angelheaded hipsters[18], street disciples[19]
Of a culture found young and lost, loved and reviled.

It's twelve years since Cos brought him here for the first time,
Saying he'd met some of the generation's best minds
Destroyed by madness[20] and absurdity, burdened
By purposelessness, beholden to urgency,

Too weak to complete their journey[21], instead twisting
Listlessly through miserable purgatory, fists
Raised violently at the Leviathan[22], lyres
Strumming melodies aimed at powers dark and light,

Pleasing to a greensleeved A&R such as him,
Settling at Dox Records[23], under his father's wing.
Keen to please the patriarch, he resolved to sign
Most talented malcontents, how woe betided!

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[17] *Howl*, Allen Ginsberg, Part II. Ginsberg says that Part II, in relation to Part I, "names the monster of mental consciousness that preys on the Lamb." Part II is about the state of industrial civilization, characterized in the poem as "Moloch". Ginsberg was inspired to write Part II during a period of peyote-induced visionary consciousness in which he saw a hotel façade as a monstrous and horrible visage which he identified with that of Moloch, the Biblical idol in Leviticus to whom the Canaanites sacrificed children. Ginsberg intends that the characters he portrays in Part I be understood to have been sacrificed to this idol. Moloch is also the name of an industrial, demonic figure in Fritz Lang's Metropolis, a film that Ginsberg credits with influencing "Howl, Part II" in his annotations for the poem (see especially Howl: Original Draft Facsimile, Transcript & Variant Versions). Most lines in this section contain the fixed base "Moloch". Ginsberg says of Part II, "Here the long line is used as a stanza form broken into exclamatory units punctuated by a base repetition, Moloch."
[18] *Howl*, Allen Ginsberg, Part 1, Line 3. “angelheaded hipsters burning for the ancient heavenly connection”.
[19] First line of Nas’ *Illmatic*, on *The Genesis*. “Street's disciple, my raps are trifle”
[20] *Howl*, Allen Ginsberg, Part 1, Line 1. “I saw the best minds of my generation destroyed by madness”
[21] “Every existing thing is born without reason, prolongs itself out of weakness, and dies by chance” - Sartre, *Nausea* (25.12)
[22] *Leviathan* by Thomas Hobbes. Written during the English Civil War (1642–1651), Leviathan argues for a social contract and rule by an absolute sovereign. Hobbes wrote that civil war and the brute situation of a state of nature ("the war of all against all") could only be avoided by strong, undivided government.
[23] Doxa (from ancient Greek δόξα, "glory", "praise" from δοκεῖν dokein, "to appear", "to seem", "to think" and "to accept") is a Greek word meaning common belief or popular opinion. Joly Dox = “Beautiful beliefs”.

A mistake he'd never make again, so he thought,
Until Cosmo's ship never made it into port.
They buried his empty grave this April morning[24]
After 2 weeks in the Port of Spezia trawling[25].

The brothers were never close, six years between them[26],
Their fraternal love a labour Sisyphean
Before Cos hit the road like Henry. He wrote
Joly a parting poem, the least he was owed.

"I've left because I wish to live deliberately,
To front on only the essential facts of life,
And see if I could learn not only what is taught,
But realise in death is when I come alive.

Sprung free from our jobs, cars, offices, and taxes,
Here in the woods, me and Waldo[27] are relaxing.
We don't work with our hands, we don't walk with our feet,
Insist upon yourself brother, insist and be free.[28]"

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[24] It is Maundy Thursday (the Thursday before Easter), the same day as the start of Dante's Inferno.
[25] Percy Bysshe Shelley died in a suspected pirate attack off the coast of Spezia.
[26] Joly is 35, the same age as Dante in *The Inferno.* Cosmo is 29.
[27] Thoreau built a house on land owned by Ralph Waldo Emerson near Walden Pond, where he lived for years and wrote Civil Disobedience.
[28] Last two quatrains are based on a passage from Walden by Henry David Thoreau. "I went to the woods because I wished to live deliberately, to front only the essential facts of life, and see if I could not learn what it had to teach, and not, when I came to die, discover that I had not lived. I did not wish to live what was not life, living is so dear; nor did I wish to practise resignation, unless it was quite necessary. I wanted to live deep and suck out all the marrow of life, to live so sturdily and Spartan-like as to put to rout all that was not life, to cut a broad swath and shave close, to drive life into a corner, and reduce it to its lowest terms, and, if it proved to be mean, why then to get the whole and genuine meanness of it, and publish its meanness to the world; or if it were sublime, to know it by experience, and be able to give a true account of it in my next excursion."

II

Mind Rain/Flight Time[29]

In short, the period was so far like the present period, that some of its noisiest authorities insisted on its being received, for good or for evil, in the superlative degree of comparison only.[30]

At the violet hour[31]60 feet under la Manche
She could almost taste Dover. Sausage roll,
Hyacinths[32]and English tea from Gare de Nord[33]
chug chug chug[34]
Norah Healy[35] was in good spirits
Complimentary when in Standard Premium.
Girls across the aisle dance the Nasternium.

Dansons la capucine[36],
Y'a pas de pain chez nous,
Y'en a chez la voisine
Mais ce n'est pas pour nous

Forever bound to you, as the old saying goes[37].
We held hands that August night down Rue de la Harpe[38]
(Possibly before it changed its name but unsure[39])
Talking at length about our dreams.
Forever will it take me to forget
Your flash-flood tears of practised anguish
That crashed silently into an oyster shell[40],
Before parting ways and wishing well.
That's the thing about good intentions,
They perform the job of paving stones[41].

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[29] The two samples on Nas' N.Y. State of Mind, second track of Illmatic
[30] Charles Dickens' A Tale of Two Cities
[31] Repeated throughout T.S. Eliot's *The Waste Land,* alludes to the repetitive nature of life
[32] T.S. Eliot's *The Wasteland, The Burial of the Dead, line 35*
[33] The triple line structure references Dante's *Inferno*
[34] "Jug, jug, jug, tereu" is originally from *Spring's Welcome* by John Lyly to describe the song of the nightingale, but used in The Fire Sermon of *The Waste Land* as well. Tereu is Tereus, ravisher of Philomena (who makes an appearance in this poem later). Jug jug is used as a crude reference to sex but also here references Norah drinking alcohol as well as the sound of the train.
[35] Maiden name of Nora Barnacle, James Joyce's wife and muse
[36] French nursery rhyme, a little like Ring Around the Rosie. Translation: "Let's dance the Nasturtium, There is no bread at home, There is some at the neighbours, But it's not for us."
[37] Shift to free verse for the letter. Also, there is no such old saying.
[38] Called Rue d'Énfer ('Road to Hell') in the 12th century. A barber and a baker carried out killings on this road that formed the basis of the Sweeney Todd story, and they have been labelled as the world's first serial killers.
[39] Name changed in the 1200s. Nod to the first line of L'Etranger "Today Mother died. Or maybe yesterday. I don't know."
[40] *The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock*, T.S. Eliot. This entire canto alludes to this poem.
[41] Play on the proverb "The road to hell is paved with good intentions", the origins of which can be traced to "facilis descensus Averno (the descent to hell is easy)" in Virgil's *Aeneid*.

Our hotel had all sorts of cool inventions,
A tad pretentious for my tastes but it came highly recommended
By one of your wet mates from Highgate and Cambridge.
Forever shall I question my choices,
But how long will this monster stay voiceless?

Wrapped up in red and yellow tape,
Hell-bent on an exit, praying for a saviour.

A tell-tale sign of malaise when we don't
Talk of rain because we've come to expect it.
A long winter of mishaps and setbacks
Trilled with flashes and hot spells,
So you don't forget how that feels.

The type of winter that makes you consider
Whether there's anything keeping you here
For the rest of your pertinent years.
Is it folly to believe that hollow trees
Should uproot and change locations?

Dansons la capucine,
Y'a pas de vin chez nous,
Y'en a chez la voisine
Mais ce n'est pas pour nous[42]

[42] Let's dance the Nasturtium, There is no wine at home, There is some at the neighbours, But it's not for us.

We smoked a fatty on the walk back from
Montmatre to your flat in Batignoles,
I'm normally nervous on a first date
But there was something in the laidback way
You pulled it out and gave it to me
That I found impossible to turn away.

Two-ply the streets were trying to walk through
In rush hour swelled with Asian tour groups
Who pause to preserve every twist and turn
Of the Seine to pretend to their friends
That they saw more of Paris than them.

You told me you knew every road in town,
Where to breakfast, lunch and dine like locals,
Which unfiltered cigarettes I should smoke
And what folk I should avoid late night
(Generally anybody with shaved heads,
Long dreads or offerers of narcotics,
Which in hindsight is ironic as it's
The only advice that was correct).

Something poetic about a December exit
After a sunny summery entrance.
I left and was struggling to comprehend
What had just happened and if it's too soon to text.
Even now I find it hard to explain,
I don't know the French for walk of shame.

Dansons la capucine
Ya de plasire chez nous
On pleure chez la voisine
On rire toujours chez nous[43]

The lights have gone off
Once again, I see.
Dieu soit loué, I finally know
I must excise this bloated growth,
This Esthesioneuroblastoma,
Taste pain no more.

Disappear into my own night
On the tail of dear Chantal Sébire[44],
Before I lose my five senses
Forever, farewell.

[43] Let's dance the Nasturtium, There is happiness at home, There are tears at the neighbors, There is always laughter at home."
[44] http://www.spiked-online.com/newsite/article/4912#.WGA7--GLRE4 (I can't do her justice in footnotes).

III

The Joker and the Thief[45]

"May God us keep from Single vision & Newtons sleep"[46]

Ensconced in a sandy man-made rock formation
They court renaissance in southern conurbations.
Three white souls all pre-wrapped in brown obfuscation[47]
First hated, now embrace anonymization.

Candlelight red on sweaty faces[48] they channel
The greats for two days straight, while reverberations
Shake them but bring no rain[49], in each man's mandible
New Mogadishu's best Khat for concentration.

"A guest in my own reality, tormented
By my covered coffin deep in the back garden
And its primal urge to grow. Had I repented
(For my sins) he might have granted me a pardon,

But now the cat's out of the box[50], we'll never know.
Can one divide life's prestige[51] by the physical?
Has the soul evolved to mere vestige? Heaven's no!
I can't forget that he was the original

And I the facsimile, god to my prophet
But a class beneath. I've won against nothingness[52]
By borrowing from my binary opposite
And between Heaven and Hell we found consensus,

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[45] All Along the Watchtower, Bob Dylan. The dualities between jokers and thieves is a major theme. This canto is supposed to invoke the song and also the philosophical film *Mindwalk*, set in the island fortress Mont Saint Michel.
[46] William Blake quote that is cited in Mindwalk
[47] William Blake, The Little Black Boy
[48] T.S. Eliot's The Wasteland, What the Thunder Said
[49] What The Thunder Said, T.S. Eliot, The Waste Land
[50] This is all a Schrodinger's Cat allegory, with some Rick and Morty/Primer/Mr Robot references thrown in there as well.
[51] The Prestige is the third act of a magic trick, the film *The Prestige* features three magicians and their ways to perform the prestige of the superhuman feat The Disappearing Man: two twins live half lives between them and the other duplicates himself every night, killing himself in the process but allowing his clone to live on in his place, at least until the next night. Ultimately neither succeeds in actually performing the trick and their psychological wranglings take their toll, resulting in the demise of two.
[52] To be or not to be" from Hamlet or "Are you a 0 or a 1?" from Mr Robot. The Myth of Sisyphus starts with "There's but one truly serious philosophical problem, and that is suicide… judging whether life is or is not worth living, that is the fundamental question of philosophy."

To each party a half-life, different loves and
Private values but unified when on display.
Unperturbed by uncertainty, eventually
Unobserved we both will be scorched or decay.'

The triple pillar[53] deem poetry martial art,
Kwame's verse jointly poured over and pulled apart.
WK, American degenerate
Next vents his current temperament.

"Most flow for encores, I talk to be uncaught,
Most speak their unthoughts, I wait til dead sure.
Zombies are dead bores, I prefer Ted talks,
Fear cousins of Hypnos[54] and polos with red shorts.

Red hots from red tops, vocals will squeeze Glocks[55],
Ink barrels and print shops flop to beat boxes.
Deliver shots to the noxious doxa,
Flock to ancient rocks, stop short and take stock.

Wristwatch tick-tocking towards twelve o'clock,
Wisped-up coiffeured locks stretched back up the top
At risk of getting lit up by candles,
Sly vandals panhandle on Sky channels,

Unscramble the preamble for real angles,
Fear strangles and jeers rankle, ample battles
Handled by the bandit but still standing,
He won't claim something he had no hand in."

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[53] *Antony and Cleopatra,* Shakespeare
[54] Reference to the Nas lyric "I never sleep, cos sleep is the cousin of Death" in N.Y. State of Mind, second track on *Illmatic*. The cousin/brother of Hypnos, god of sleep, is Thanatos, the god of Death.
[55] "*It Ain't Hard to Tell", Illmatic*, Nas

Rufio, il miglior fabbro[56],
consiros ve la passada folor[57]

"You asked me about a David Foster Wallace article
That he wrote about a Maine lobster festival.
I reply, the ocean knows best of all.
You say, who put an end to Yorick's infinite jest[58]?
I tell you it was time, who leaves no one left.
Anduve como vosotros escarbando la estrella interminable[59],
Tenet insanabile multos scribendi cacoethes[60],
Doctor calls it hypergraphia.
You ask about Russian cursive that looks like an exploding heart[61],
And with mauvaise foi if Sartre loved Simone De Beauvoir[62].

Living lives of avarice in a timeline less glamorous,
Tiny hand-outs from the slanderous pussygrabbers.
Caught the bald eagle moulting on the Oval floor,
Every film I see is normalising civil war.

Last night did we dream the theft of democracy
By Macedonian teens on new Macbook screens
And the skeeter hawks in the home of sheet metal,
Sex pesterers of livestock quadrupedal?
Oh wie ist das schön, oh wie ist das schön,
So was hat man lange nicht gesehen, so schön[63],
The wisdom of crowds. Pass me my phone.

Alas the bell tolls[64], Phi the Piper needs paying.
Adieu, mes amis. Je vais a la gloire[65]!"

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[56] This is both Eliot's dedication to Ezra Pound at the start of *The Waste Land,* and also Dante's description of Arnaut Daniel, lauded by Ezra Pound in the *The Spirit of Romance* (1910) as the greatest poet to have ever lived.
[57] In Dante's *The Divine Comedy* Arnaut Daniel is a character who speaks in Old Occitan. When asked who he is he replies "Ieu sui Arnaut, que plor e vau cantan; consiros vei la passada folor, e vei jausen lo joi qu'esper, denan", meaning "I am Arnaut, who weeping and singing go; Contrite I see the folly of the past, And, joyous, I foresee the joy I hope for one day."
[58] Hamlet, but also Foster Wallace's Infinite Jest
[59] Neruda's *Enigmas*, "I walked around as you do, investigating the endless star". Whole stanza is in Neruda's style.
[60]Derived from *Satires* by Juvenal. "Tenet insanabile multos scribendi cacoethes", meaning "The incurable desire (or itch) for writing affects many"
[61] https://www.thepoke.co.uk/wp-content/uploads/2016/07/CmNe3KsWIAETB_4.jpg
[62] Both Sartre and De Beauvoir talked of 'bad faith' the phenomenon where human beings under pressure from social forces adopt false values and disown their innate freedom hence acting inauthentically. They also had an open relationship.
[63] German football chant meaning "Oh how nice, oh how nice, you didn't see something like that for a long time, oh how nice."
[64] John Donne (1572-1631), Devotions Upon Emergent Occasions, Meditation XVII: Nunc Lento Sonitu Dicunt, Morieris. "Perchance he for whom this bell tolls may be so ill, as that he knows not it tolls for him; and perchance I may think myself so much better than I am, as that they who are about me, and see my state, may have caused it to toll for me, and I know not that.
[65] Last words of Isadora Duncan, before her scarf got caught in the wheel of the car she was in and snapped her neck.

“Thanks again for letting me stay here my brother.
It's weird I feel like I've gone deep undercover.
From the sounds of things we getting down underground.
You gotta give me some history, a quick background.”

“Deeply imprinted in children of influence
Lives a conviction carved from continuance.
Even in crystalis, gods in the embryo,
pampered in Champneys, peppered in prep school.

Wimpy and charming, in love with their fathers,
Rather than argue they force nervous laughter.
After all A-stars they depart to pater's alma mater,
Smarter than half the class but no one talks faster.

Hard is the battle so bravado takes charge.
So long they walked this path, so long it lasts.
The legendary sword of Damocles hangs heavy
Over a Politics, Philosophy and Economics[66] degree.

Logically a high proportion of these so-called
Thought-leaders lead us, some others tap our phonecalls.
That was my future, but I had no more path to follow.
Neither protocol was adequate, no pill that I could swallow[67].

[66] https://www.theguardian.com/education/2017/feb/23/ppe-oxford-university-degree-that-rules-britain
[67] Matrix, bitch. But yeah also people are taking waaaaay too many drugs in this country. And not the good ones.

I failed a stress test and my consciousness went stage left.
The next step, I quit uni and Oxford in the same breath.
That night I found an open mic and wrecked bars.
Rufie saw and said I was for sure a born star,

He took me out to his sports car in the car park
And brought along two hardcore pornstars in sports bras.
Well, not for long... We partied all fortnight and more,
Then when he asked me to move in here I said “Sure,

I'm always up in here smoking or recording,
I may as well move my futon and skateboard in.”
“How can you afford all this? You man are ballin”.
“Landlady's sweet on Ru, sometimes she comes a'callin.

More often she drops him a text summoning him
Like 5 minutes ago when he went off scurrying.”
“Penetration for accommodation? Madting.
But I guess it beats a studio flat in Acton.”

“Word.”

IV

The Fire Sermon[68]

Midway upon the journey of our life, I found myself in a dark wilderness, for I had wandered from the straight and true.[69]

Dawn close, Sunset closed and spat characters like phlegm[70]
Out onto the streets, night stars their resurrection[71].
Joly wallowed with bottle[72] by a bridge and waxed
Lyrical about two things he couldn't buy back[73].

"We are falling[74], like the recurring dream that brings
Morning rushing in and cold sweat to my dry skin,
Into pandemonium[75]. Is nothing here real?
Dwelling under rotten smoke[76], black clouds hold ill will[77].

I need residents of Poet's Cemetery
To represent me[78], at Tolstoy's Farm[79] with Ghandi[80]
No hand can bring me harm, but without suffering
There's no sanctity[81]. Canvases of paintless brushings,

Nostalgic for a slow-motion past, filtered fun
Memories more vivid than in pre-production.
On every eyelid an advertisement, tiny
Jewels glued around the brow - proud, playful and shiny.

The greatest poets, the ones they still speak about
Live eternal like worshipped deities, devout
Followers finding fresh focus, freed from fatal
Inertia and banal versions of stale fables,

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[68] Title of the third canto in *The Waste Land*
[69] Start of Dante's Inferno
[70] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas. "Wipe the sweat off my dome, spit the phlegm on the streets."
[71] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas. "My strength, my son, the star will be my resurrection". Nas' son is called Knight.
[72] *Grief, I Don't Like Shit, I Don't Go Outside*, Earl Sweatshirt. "Find a bottle, I'mma wallow when I lie in that."
[73] Grief, I Don't Like Shit, I Don't Go Outside, Earl Sweatshirt. Earl is the Joker to Nas' thief in this book, representing the West coast (LA) to Nas' East (NY). Every track in *IDLSIDGO* is referenced in the equivalent canto of this book.
[74] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas. " I keep falling, but never falling six feet deep."
[75] Capital of Hell in Milton's Paradise Lost.
[76] "Dwelling in the Rotten Apple, you get tackled", "To my man Ill Will, God bless your life" and "I need a new nigga for this black cloud to follow"
[77] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas
[78] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas
[79] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas. "I'm out for dead presidents to represent me"
[80] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas. "I sip the Dom P, watching Gandhi 'til I'm charged"
[81] Ghandi, Satyagraha in South Africa, p. 18. "Real suffering bravely borne melts even a heart of stone. Such is the potency of suffering or tapas. And there lies the key to Satyagraha"

Stable tales and hailed babies. In worldplay surfs rise
To merchants. The gentry are landed, for turned eyes
A peerage and three letters for your loyalty.
Some proles master prose and ascend above royalty,

Gods in realities of their apostles
But mere students in their own, now worthless fossils.
Is expertise not mastery of thesaurus
And dictionary? Intelligence withdraws us

From savagery, vocabulary from blindness.
The laughing beggar bathes below in divineness
Cast down from the retrograde moon, now the water
Follows the fish[82] and the lambs refuse slaughter,

The truth defies the lines drawn out to confine it,
Spilling like oil from an unpluggable pipeline
To dilute rivers of life-giving water.
In my dumb presence I'm as much a supporter

As the fingers that take aim and pull the triggers.
We clutch to traditions like censoring n-------.
The century turned and we were warned of the triumph
Of bullshit[83], decades later they banned Naked Lunch,

Ulysses, Howl, Animal Farm and Brave New World[84].
Would Cos be alive if I'd understood his words?
Good grief, it seems that I've been reaping what I sowed[85].
Born alone, die alone[86], I'm living what they wrote[87].

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[82] Dawning of the Age of Aquarius.
[83]A "burn" poem directed by the young T. S. Eliot against his critics, and his female critics in particular. Unpublished during his lifetime, it first appeared in the posthumous volume Inventions of the March Hare: Poems 1909-1917 (1997). According to the Oxford English Dictionary, the title contains the first recorded instance of the word "bullshit" (though the term had probably been floating around in popular slang for a while before that). The second, third, and fourth recorded instances, by the way, belong to Ezra Pound, Wyndham Lewis, and E. E. Cummings. Next time you call something bullshit, you can congratulate yourself on your sophisticated literary putdown.
[84] All heavily referenced in this work. The banning of a book is in effect its death, which like the premature death of a human, gives it eternal significance. Books however can be unbanned/resurrected.
[85] Grief, Earl Sweatshirt. "Good grief, I been reaping what I sowed, nigga I ain't been outside in a minute I been living what I wrote." Earl wrote this song last on *I Don't Like Shit, I Don't Go Outside* while he was ill, stuck inside, living what he wrote.
[86] *The World is Yours*, Illmatic, Nas.
[87] Earl refers to writers in his situation in the past but also knows that other people that are in the same situation when they hear this record will will hear him saying these lines and know that somebody else was in this place before, even if Earl may now have moved on mentally. Earl's father Keorapetse Kgositsile is a South African revolutionary poet who who predicted violence would destroy the current, last generation of poets, in one of his works. This inspired a group known as the Last Poets, several groups of poets and musicians who arose from the late 1960s African-American civil rights movement's black nationalist movement and released some of the earliest hip-hop style records. Earl could more specifically be talking about *Random Notes To My Son*, which starts "Beware, my son, words that carry the loudnesses of blind desire also carry the slime of illusion dripping like pus from the slave's battered back." Incidentally Nas' father legendary jazz musician Olu Dara also appears *Illmatic*, playing trumpet on *Life's a Bitch*.

No more chipped-tooth smiles to serpents[88], time is urgent
But there's solace in reality's divergence.
From shoulders of Atlas to wrinkled infant hands[89],
We watch this world end with a whimper, not a bang.[90]"

This is the way the world ends
This is the way the world ends
This is the way the world ends
This is the way the world ends

[88] Nas The World Is Yours, Illmatic
[89] Donald J. Trump has tiny hands.
[90] Final stanza of *The Hollow Men*, T.S. Eliot

Act II

Good Friday

V

To Real Friends

C'est que notre ame, helas! n'est pas assez hardie. [91]

I found it calming for my mental state
To co-habitate with a depressant,
Augmenting this social experiment
By inventing an alias identity

That surrogated all my pain for me,
While my true personality hibernated
Within my psyche, complete but fragmented.
My golden locum tenens was created whole

But programmed with self-destruction codes
Rigged to blow and explode this new soul,
Flowing through the original pieces
With the effect of connecting and gilting,

Improving the whole just as kintsugi
Renews a disintegrated ricebowl.

[91] "It's because our soul, alas, is not bold enough." Baudelaire, Les Fleurs du Mal

She gave the bell a ring, found it was still working,
Waited grinning at her imperfect offering[92]
Then rushed headlong into the welcoming embrace
Of Captain Never, ever her fidus Achates[93].

"What have you been doing?" "You know me. Nevering.
Last week at the old job then back to couchsurfing.
Come in so we can catch up properly, old friend.
It's so good to see you again! I won't pretend

I wasn't crushed when you left but I understood,
If that happened to me then I'm not sure I could
Forgive and forget, but as you know I've always
Been a slave to regret. Next time call me, okay?"

She agreed and they sat on the settee, watching
MTV and from these helpful teacups quaffing
A cocktail of their own green invention; cola, lime
And large quantities of at-hand aqua vitae

Mixed with space oddities and novelty grinders
Filled with plants sometimes used to treat one's night blindness,
Chiming on timeless classics and New Romantics,
Drug rackets, Barbour jackets, Slow Hands on Antics,

Blanket bans on Islam, right-wing coalitions,
And the Noonday gun from Mad Dogs and Englishmen,
Fallen angels from Donnington and Teddington[94],
Til the cloak eroded, and fear set in again.

---

[92] Leonard Cohen, “Ring The Bell That Still Can Ring”
[93] Aeneas’ loyal friend in *The Aeneid*, Virgil
[94] Noel Coward, author of *Mad Dogs and Englishmen*, is from Teddington. Late of the Pier, from Castle Donnington, recorded a song called *Mad Dogs and Englishmen*. Little nod to Ross Wilson from Late of The Pier who died in 2014.

VI

Burial

"I rap divine, God; check the prognosis: is it real or showbiz?"[95]

"I feel no guilt, neither should you my firstborn son.
This month has been too cruel, I seek the snow once more[96].
Cosmo's request was heavy and his solution
Saline as his darkened tomb on the ocean floor,

Intended to render our potable water
Unpalatable in each mouthful and
Nausea-inducing, as if I'd lost a daughter.
I see through his final disappointing demand.

I feel no guilt, less than his first disappearance
Or his return home with earrings aged fifteen. By
Severest words and schemes never redeemed, therehence
Spiritual abandonment of my child gave rise,

I'll admit to that. I lament each passing year
Your mother wrote "Excuse my dust[97]" on her gravestone.
Eventually adjacent, mine shall instead demand fear[98]
In all living producers of testosterone.

---

[95] Nas, Memory Lane, Illmatic
[96] April is the cruelest month" First line of *The Waste Land*, Eliot
[97] Dorothy Parker, *Vanity Fair* interview, 1925
[98] "I will show you fear in a handful of dust", The Waste Land, Eliot

I feel no guilt. O ye men who dwell in streets of
Lacedemon! O this night, alack alack alack[99]!
Reports from Jerusalem that the city
Which had taken the whole world was sacked[100],

Urban images shrouded in black smoke.
Regard Alaric, son of Rothesteus.
Would I remain recalcitrant as Sabbas
And fill my lungs with Danubian water

To meet glorious saints in the Bastille,
Drunk on liberty and enthusiasm[101]?
I say Non, sire, c'est une revolution[102],
What doesn't kill one only makes one stronger

So close your mouth and perform your ablutions,
The Lady's not the only one for turning
But now that's the only solution, so the crowd
Believes on the streets of Lutetia and Mamucium[103].

---

[99] A MidSummer Night's Dream
[100] "My voice sticks in my throat; and, as I dictate, sobs choke my utterance. The City which had taken the whole world was itself taken." Jerome, Letter CXXVII (To Principia)

[101]The two quatrains contain references to the 410 AD Sack of Rome
[102] Reference to François Alexandre Frédéric, duc de la Rochefoucauld-Liancourt. On 12 July, two days before the storming of the Bastille, he warned Louis XVI of the state of affairs in Paris, and met his exclamation that there was a revolt with the answer, "Non, sire, c'est une révolution." ("No, majesty, it is a revolution.")
[103]Roman names of Paris and a Roman province near Manchester

Anyway son, I called you up for a reason.
At the weekly meat-up with the Latymer lot,
Cohen told me all about “Generation Lost”
And how they are committing musical treason,

Hiding their identities and never playing
Songs twice. From what I’ve heard you saying in the past,
You won’t let this fleeting opportunity pass.
I don’t think this time we will be saved by praying,

My stock market maven explained we could be
Taken over in the next few months, I sold shares
I thought I could afford to, but they were all paired
And grouped, and we’re looking weaker than we should be.

I’m not losing this fucking company Joly.
Go sign this fucking band and make me some money.
I hate to point out it was all milk and honey
Before I hired you, now I’m fucked royally.

Delphine told me you saw the band after the wake
On some guest list for you and little brother,
Did you think that fact was something she could cover?
To honour Cosmo’s death this is all it will take,

While making a huge difference to the existence
Of the family business. Any questions, son?
Bare in mind I’m not giving you an option,
If at first you don’t succeed, show some persistence.”

“Just the one, have you always been deluded Dad
Or perhaps you caught a touch of the sun today?
Lost Generation are anonymous, some say
They’ve deleted all shreds they exist, or ever had.

How am I supposed to carry out your mad task?
Wine and dine the leader with dinner and a flick?
Slide up in the DMs and send a nice dick pic?
Go up to them while performing and calmly ask?

I don’t appreciate your insinuation,
And I don’t know why you have to make me feel bad.
What do you want me to say? Yes I may have had
Some flops, but they’re hazards of the occupation.

I’m not you, and for that I’m thankful every day.
You’re soulless for throwing Cosmo’s death in my face,
And you alone should bear what’s happened to this place.
I should have expected you’d throw this shit my way.

I’m going to the pub, it’s Eliza’s birthday.
I’ve had more than enough of your accusations.
Don’t ask me again about Lost Generation.
If you need me urgently I’m Notting Hill way.“

“Mr Dox, I have a call for you. It's... Destiny.”

VII

ANTI[104] gOne[105] isH[106]

"WORK WORK WORK WORK WORK"

WK, back in town for a gig that night
With his band Raptors of Vertigo, occupied
Nearly all of the right hand side of the pub with
His party. The whole band was there, sat to his

Left the bassist Rückenfigur, so called as he
Never faces the crowd. "They call it L'Etranger[107]
In Algeria. Self-improvement is merely
Clothed masturbation. Self-destruction is clearly

The path to true salvation[108]." To the right of him
The pub's proprietor Bootsy Q. Straight-edged in
Consumption of narcotics himself but willing
Supplier of drugs from ouzo to heroin,

The root cause of the rueful loss of his partner
In crime and wife Anti (short for Antonia).
Since then he swore off the sauce but plugged in at source
To a silk road, reason and action divorced.

---

[104] ANTI by Rihanna. Over the red, black and white canvas of the album cover there is a poem written in Braille by poet Chloe Mitchell; the braille follows the theme of the album's singles artwork which also features the same technique. Speaking on her choice to use the language, Rihanna commented, "Sometimes the ones who have sight are the blindest." Anti is also the nickname of Bootsy's dead wife Antonia, and her spirit and blood still haunt the pub, so she is only goneish.
[105] *One Love*, Illmatic, Nas and Antigone.
[106] Antigonish. The ish also reflects the fact that the story only loosely resembles that of Antigone. The capitalised H at the end is a nod to Bootsy's namesake Schoolboy Q, who capitalises all of his Hs. He tweeted in 2011 "wHy my H always capitalized???? HIIIPOWER X HIPPY X HOOVER X HEAVEN & HELL AKA MY LIFE"
[107]L'Etranger/The Outsider by Camus. The Stranger is also a masturbatory technique where one sits on their hand until it goes numb.
[108]Tyler Durden, Fight Club https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VD54p_NdpTY

"There was a queer chap from Bohemia
A poor victim of hypoxyphilia
He wanted the chop
But Suzanne was no cop
On reflection it would have been easier.[109]"

"This is Hannah, she went to school with Eliza,
She's a part-time model and mortgage adviser
Who claims to have never even heard of the Raptors!
I say we should wow her and leave her in raptures.

Forever scratching pen on a pad
So maybe one day fire starts catching
So maybe one day I can start relaxing
A nervous mind of a kind that isn't kind towards inaction

Factor in a fraction of my faction, eat the porridge by the bowl
The rest are unemployed, wanted, bailed or on parole
Last week we had a party right, a friend's send off night
We partied 25 hours, then we bruised his eyes

We do the right things but for the wrong guys
We take you by surprise in the middle of the night
You'd better revise your attitude before I really get mad at you
I've had it dude I'm throwing bows, better tell the dentist to be expecting you

Call the dentist bitch! Make an appointment quick.
Cos I'm coming for your arse and I never miss.
Put a MC down like an anesthetist,
You're gonna need to call work and take off a week or six.

I'm like water man, I'm in a fluid state,
My chi's banging in line, I feel fucking great.
Have you had a goji berry? Man the shit's bananas
Harder than the hiragana, katakana and the kanji.

---

[109]On September 2, 1791 while he was in London, Czech violist Frantisek Kotzwara visited a prostitute named Susannah Hill in Vine Street, Westminster. After dinner with her in her lodgings, Kotzwara paid her two shillings and requested that she cut off his testicles. Hill refused to do so. Kotzwara then tied a ligature around the doorknob, the other end fastened around his neck, and proceeded to have sexual intercourse with Hill. After it was over, Kotzwara was dead. His is one of the first recorded deaths from erotic asphyxiation.

Shot two, living in the city it's too hot to
Find out who shot you, Roboto or Mugatu
Too true to handle, you got blue sandals[110]
And 16 candles in the Sistine Chapel.

Vandalize headlines, compromise deadlines
Crossing over red lines and small t's, dotting i's
Restful APIs too active to stand still,
Chilling with ill will, no tearful farewells.

Fixed on 6 songs and sticky bombs, read on.
Six black wings on his back, waist and thighs frozen,
Higher than a Swanton, twisting like a wanton,
Chandon by the bottle to throttle thoughts of mans gone.

Where's the lady in the van gone? Camden Council
Got no leg to stand on. Random mandem
Handing round ounces in shards of glass
Placed in hearts of darkness, en garde!

Swiped right too hard, I might have to charge,
Bars shut early sunday, who got the free yard
For us to rest in, two twos a two for two,
If Bossman blesses with wings, perfection.

Toss my best bredrin the steel protection,
Got the best deal on some real Smith and Westons,
Copped the receipt from the dealer's receptionist,
Buyer's remorse is the worst when it's corpses.

Divorced from the truth, our realities groupies
A fuck thing, a screw fix, a blow toy, a chew piece,
Corrupted contortions of usual suspects,
For up here, my success is nothing.

I'm a villain in my aspect, thinking of the casket,
Criminal mindset, shrinking violet,
Swilling the decanter, drinking in the banter,
Sitting in the gastro, spitting fully gassed flows."

[110] MF DOOM, Figaro, Madvillainy "It's too hot to handle, you got blue sandals"

Hannah applauds as her boyfriend strides over towards
Them with his guard up and a fraught furrowed forehead,
Eyes and fists fixed on WK's nose and chin.
"What you doing over here with my girlfriend, "bredrin"?

The brawl starts just as Norah and Captain enter
The door. Bootsy, bored of fighting makes a gesture
To go upstairs and they navigate the violence
To talk alone in a quieter environment.

Milos hailed from a rural trail on Mykonos
But lost his island ethos in the land of the slobs
And slags[111], with a grammar school accent he practised
As there's enough flack being gay in the parish.

He moved to the big smoke, brother Marcos followed
When old enough to fly solo like a swallow[112],
And they lived near the old Portobello Market.

Somewhere along the way they both gained
Best friends that took them in directions
That they would never have imagined.

---

[111] Britain, but also the school Milo Yiannopoulous attended - Simon Langton All Boys was abbreviated to SLABS/SLOBS and the girls school unfortunately to SLAGS.

[112]"The Princess: O Swallow" Alfred, Lord Tennyson

Milos learned that the hate and rejection,
He engendered made him great at agitation,
Which he used to write hate-filled think pieces
Aimed at dreadful braindead airwastes.

Bootsy also found a flair for feeding foulness to his so-called friends,
Working in pubs and low-key dealing on the side.
He did a short stretch and met Huck Anderson on the inside.
It’s safe to say this encounter changed his life.

“Yesterday upon the floor
I saw a stain not there before
It wasn't there again today
I wish, I wish she'd go away.

When I came home last night at three
The woman waited there for me
But when I looked around the hall
I couldn't see her there at all”

VII

Portrait of Destiny[113]

"My salad days, when I was green in judgement: cold in blood, to say as I said then!"

"Hello there. Yes I'll hold. It's Destiny Vegas."

Destiny Vegas lay in her burnished[114] parlour,
Completely enveloped by Dante's Sonata[115],
The triumphant close to her favourite stage
Of Liszt's masterpiece, Années de Pèlerinage[116].

A google search tells you her real name is Anna
But in a most typically public school manner
Her Channing classmates used Bartholomew, although
Her doting parents called her Annie at home

Until too soon she had grown into something
That they no longer understood and feared, teeming
With teenage self-confidence and juvenile dread,
Peering through the looming glass ceiling overhead

Into cloudy darkened dooms some two or three[117],
Smiling at all those situations yet unseen,
Baring white cleavage, legs, soul and teeth at faces
Uncaring when viewed from the cold nether places.

Her schism's nominative self-determinism.
When the day finally came to make the decision
For the first time in her life: What should her name be?
Anna Bartholomew isn't a celebrity.

---

[113] Portrait of a Lady, T.S. Eliot
[114] Antony and Cleopatra, Act II, Scene II, Enobarbus "The barge she sat in, like a burnish'd throne", also the opening line of A Game of Chess, The Waste Land, T.S. Eliot "The Chair she sat in, like a burnished throne"
[115] Après une lecture de Dante: Fantasia Quasi Sonata (After Reading Dante: Fantasia Quasi Sonata) in D minor
[116] The title Années de pèlerinage refers to Goethe's famous novel of self-realization, Wilhelm Meister's Apprenticeship, and especially its sequel Wilhelm Meister's Journeyman Years. Liszt clearly places the work in line with the Romantic literature of his time, prefacing most pieces with a literary passage from writers such as Schiller, Byron or Senancour, and, in an introduction to the entire work, writing.
[117] Portrait of a Lady, line 10 ("So intimate, this Chopin, that I think his soul should be resurrected only among friends some two or three, who will not touch the bloom")

How will I make them remember me?
What's my name?
Though I should have been somebody else long before,
On the ocean floor is the hermit crab reborn[118].

Destiny Manifest sits necking straight absinthe,
Measuring out her life with a silver teaspoon[119].
In whispering coolness begins young nature's play[120],
Stirring Spring phenomena clear motivation.

She took advantage of the height of her shoes and
Snuck a look above the parapet, amused by
Competitors unwilling to get their feet wet,
She knew to reap success she'd have to use her mind,

As well as her other more saleable assets.
Her internal attic dressed with some Robert Greene
And her sparse wardrobe with yet sparser new outfits,
She set out to make the rain fall from the ceiling.

Years later her therapist would ask if Eddie
Vegas was just another cog in her plan, or
She'd finally found true love, and she was ready
To shift lanes and ease off the accelerator?

Did she see the value in powerless men? Had
She forgiven her ex? How she could just pretend
That her latest expansion was legitimate?
Is this hostile takeover just petty revenge?

"Thanks for holding, putting you on now."

"Hello Ron."

---

[118] The Love Song of J Alfred Prufrock ("I should have been a pair of ragged claws scuttling across the floors of silent seas.")
[119] Slightly cheesey rhyme form change from AABB to very rough ABAB to indicate liberal character change
[120] Première année: Suisse: Au bord d'une source (Beside a Spring) in A♭ major – Liszt's caption is from Schiller: "In the whispering coolness begins young nature's play."

Act III

Holy Saturday

IX

Of The Sympathetic Dead

"When I look into the clouds I know you look down on me right next to grandmammy and the rest of the ones who wanna see me happy[121]"

Broken plates sit atop the table. Delphine tried
Waiting patiently, to no avail. She then cried
For as long as she was able, an ill-conceived
Plan to show her absent man see she was aggrieved.

Her rage smoldered within, bubbling like a cauldron
Boiling poison for he who made her beholden.
Finally she embraced solitude, emboldened.
Silence like handcuffs and handshakes, can be golden.

"Now in your eternal stillness, do you see different?
Do you have infinite wisdom and know all the secrets?
Is there beauty and uniqueness in all God's creatures?
Do you know Jesus? Is Inception's end a dream sequence?'

Will the meek inherit the earth and curse of fame[122]?
Is there a Delphine version that saves you from fate,
Worse am I the only one that lost you to the grave?
I couldn't take it, there's so much more that I want to say.

First I thought you were bluffing but still you're not here,
I don't blame you, sometimes this world's too much to bare.
You saw so much suffering, let me take the pain now
Let me take on everything with a brave face now

Let me take the weight of the world in my hands
Let me bring fear to the molecules of sand
Let me shed a tear for the fight I never fought
Let my head clear and unlearn what I've been taught."

---

[121] DNA, IDLSIDGO, Earl Sweatshirt.

[122] "Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth. " Matthew 5:3. It is very helpful to know that this line, like almost all of the beatitudes, is a quote from the Jesus' scriptures, specifically Psalm 37:11. In that verse the Hebrew word for "meek" is anav. It is also translated humble, afflicted or poor. Moses was called the most "anav" (humble) man on earth. It is often used to describe the people who called out to God for help in their difficulty, instead of being aggressive in fighting for their own way. The theme of Psalm 37 is to remind us that when we are wronged, we shouldn't try to get revenge, but to trust in the fact that God will someday set the world straight.

“Evening Delph. What’s new?” “Writing a song, I think. You?”

“Getting ice for this eye, scuffle at Eliza’s,
Some trouble with a couple of Bootsy’s free riders
Last night I walked the canal, ice was burning in
My eyes. Vexilla regis prodeunt inferni[123].

I’ve decided to get out of here for a while,
You know how Cosmo used to? Your husband is vile,
(No offence) and an outrageous hypocrite
Who I no longer wish to deal with, I’ll quit

The business and the family home, anything to get
Out from under this unpayable lifelong debt.”
“We let him control our lives like marionettes,
Clearly he fears the overthrow of god by prophet.”

“I've had enough now, you both need to stop it.
That hand whisk isn’t necessary Joly, drop it.
I intend to whisk you away now down the Thames,
Then you’ll be reintroduced to some old friends.”

[123] These four lines reference the four rounds of the Ninth Circle of Hell in Dante’s Inferno, Caina, Antenora, Ptolomaea and Jucecca. “Vexilla regis prodeunt inferni” is direct from the Inferno and means “The banners of the King of Hell draw closer”.

X

The Masque of Anarchy[124]

"Then all cried with one accord, "Thou art King and God and Lord; Anarchy, to thee we bow, be thy name made holy now!"

When Joly stopped cowering, the masked prowler
Then brought his charges to Rufio's Watchtower
By boat, arriving here a few minutes ago
Perfectly in time for the start of tonight's show.

"It's insane man, why do we listen to politicians,
It's deranged man, you don't have to be the motherfucking
Rainman to see things need to change and it's not long
Til we're up in arms like Russell Brand was saying.

Boris bought some water cannons, fucker ain't playing
I tried to join the riot club but had no way of paying,
My homie that was slinging, I spent a bill bailing,
If it's meant to be a welfare state, then it's failing.

So we got to take the reins now baby,
Start some new posses and brigades now maybe.
Show these motherfuckers we got brains already
They can take you for a ride, I'm not one to idolise.

If we combine full hearts and clear minds we can't lose[125]
There's no need to compromise, fuck another man's shoes.
We just need to strategise with a singular view.
You're not worth more than me, I'm not worth more than you."

[124] Samuel Beckett's Malone Dies: "What I sought, when I struggled out of my hole, then aloft through the stinging air towards an inaccessible boon, was the rapture of vertigo, the letting go, the fall, the gulf, the relapse to darkness, to nothingness, to earnestness, to home, to him waiting for me always, who needed me, and whom I needed, who took me in his arms and told me to stay with him always, who gave me his place and watched over me, who suffered every time I left him, whom I have often made suffer and seldom contented, whom I have never seen." This inspired the title of the first track on Up The Bracket by The Libertines, 'Vertigo'.

[125] Rallying cry in Friday Night Lights. It's still technically Friday night/Saturday morning.

“Why did we all let it come to this?
Why did we all let it come to this?
Why did we all let it come to this?
Why did we all let it come to this?”

“Unbeaten, when I'm on the mic the edge of the seat’s
Is all that you’ll be needing, stay reading,
My education’s Sisyphean, look it up and see
I'm who you wanna be with. Cut to mine

We’re having a time on Kwame’s laptop, talking to girls with our tops off,
Making them do the diplo, Twerking’s so official,
Chatroulette’s official, take down her initials
Captain is a fiend for girls with modelling potential

I just like a girl that speaks her mind
I tell her all the time her heart’s the only one in mine
I tell her that’s she’s beautiful, she tell’s me that I’m lying
Fuck it then I’m going to play some Destiny online.”

“Faces wholly beshrouded in red-dyed dowlas,
Baseless holy growlings like Howl on laughing gas.
Ephemeral performances unetherised[126],
Everyone knew they were part of "History", besides

The reformed deceased[127], they know fame is misery.
We mourn them ceaselessly, the sewers of livery,
Playing to gaunt hands and cerebral thought police,
On trial for obscenities, lovers of free speech.

---

[126] When the evening is spread out against the sky. Like a patient etherized upon a tableThe Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock, T.S. Eliot

[127] “Everyone knew they were part of ‘History” except the deceased who never knew exactly what was happening even when I was alive"— *Death and Fame*, Alan Ginsberg

Surge too fast and catch chills in the church[128], go too slow
It's heatstroke, either way one's for it, this we know
But the urge to purge for weddings and funerals
Keeps us fainting-fit til we crumple like rag dolls,

Beautiful jackals face-painting Roman numerals
On to their public facades like macabre murals.
Pleasure thrills of the brightly lit streets of Algiers,
Blood, sweat and tears flood, trapped in a mud nap for 12 years.

The streets where we from bred the bad seeds, casually
Made casualties[129] and plaintives of bad tragedies,
Treated more poorly than old Salamano's dog,
Growing out of the silence, countless angsty blogs

And pogroms on society's highest echelons,
Who feed on the worst sin under the sun:
Creating desire but denying gratification,
False freedom in my eyes, and so I take action.

Some know the purpose of your presence here tonight,
Some are caught blindsided. Soon we'll pass a solution,
So those who join us shall suffer no sickness in transit.
Remainers may drink too, but it may hasten your combustion.

There's not much left to say but that it's better to burn
Out in an ecstasy of joy and rage than fade away in
The eternal raptures of vertigo. Ty, flee this arid plain
And set our lands in order[130]. Represent[131]. Shantih[132]."

---

[128] These two quatrains reference *L'Etranger (The Outsider)* by Albert Camus.

[129] "We are all sinners won't you send us to Bible study faster, your hypocritesque reaction a blasphemy, I assassin my casualty and it's casually done" Kendrick Lamar, *RIgamortis, Section 80*

[130] I sat upon the shore, Fishing, with the arid plain behind me, Shall I at least set my lands in order? London Bridge is falling down falling down falling down, *Poi s'ascose nel foco che gli affina, Quando fiam uti chelidon* - O swallow swallow, *Le Prince d'Aquitaine a la tour abolie" V. What The Thunder Said, T.S. Eliot, The Wasteland*

[131] Illmatic

[132] Wasteland ends with discordant text and then Shantih. Shantih. Shantih, Sanskrit for peace.